“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 9

The Description of the Wish-fulfilling Tree of Bhakti

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the Anubhāṣya, 2026)

1 I worship the glorious Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, the guru of the whole world, by whose mercy even a dog can easily swim across the great ocean.[1]

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Gauracandra! Glory, glory to Advaita, and glory, glory to Nityānanda!

3 Glory, glory to Śrīvāsa and all the devotees of Gaura, whose remembrance fulfils every desire!

4 I remember also Śrī Rūpa, Sanātana, Raghunātha Bhaṭṭa, Śrī Jīva, Gopāla Bhaṭṭa and Raghunātha Dāsa.

5 By the mercy of them all I write of the pastimes and qualities of Śrī Caitanya. Whether I understand them or not, I do it for my own purification.

6 I take shelter of Śrī Caitanya, who is Himself the gardener and Himself the immortal tree of love for Kṛṣṇa, and who both gives away its fruits and enjoys them.[2]

7 The Lord said to Himself: “I bear the name Viśvambhara, ‘He who fills the universe’. My name will be true if I fill the universe with love.”[3]

8 Thinking thus, the Lord took up the work of a gardener and began to lay out an orchard in Navadvīpa.

9 Bringing it to the earth, the gardener Śrī Caitanya planted the wish-fulfilling tree of bhakti and watered it with the water of His will.

10 Glory to Śrī Mādhava Purī, brimming with love for Kṛṣṇa! He is the first sprout of the wish-fulfilling tree of bhakti.[4]

11 In the form of Śrī Īśvara Purī the sprout grew strong, and then the gardener, Śrī Caitanya Himself, became the trunk of the tree.[5]

12 By His own inconceivable power the gardener became the trunk, the original support of all the branches.

13–15 At the base of the tree nine roots sprang up: Paramānanda Purī and Keśava Bhāratī, Brahmānanda Purī and Brahmānanda Bhāratī, Viṣṇu Purī, Keśava Purī, Kṛṣṇānanda Purī, Śrī Nṛsiṁha Tīrtha and Sukhānanda Purī. On them the tree stood immovable.[6]

16 The central root is Paramānanda Purī, a man of great steadfastness, and on these nine roots the tree stood secure.[7]

17 From the trunk many branches grew, and as they rose higher and higher, they became countless.

18 The branches grew in circles of twenty, and the mighty boughs covered all the universes.

19 Each branch put out hundreds of smaller ones. Who can count how many sprang up?

20 I shall list the names of the chief branches further on; now hear the description of the tree.[8]

21 Higher up, the tree branched into two trunks: one is named Advaita, and the other Nityānanda.[9]

22 Many branches sprang from those two trunks, and their offshoots covered the world.[10]

23 Great branches, smaller branches and their offshoots filled the world. Who could ever write them all down?

24 Disciples, the disciples of disciples and their followers spread over the world beyond all counting.

25 As the udumbara fig bears fruit on all its limbs, so the tree of bhakti bears fruit everywhere.

26 On the branches and offshoots of the main trunk grew the fruit of love, sweeter than nectar.

27 When the fruit of love ripened, sweet as nectar, the gardener Caitanya gave it away and asked no price.

28 All the wealth and jewels of the three worlds I would not count as the price of a single fruit.

29 Whether one asks or not, whether one is worthy or unworthy, He does not consider; He simply gives.

30 Filling His hands again and again, He scatters the fruit in all directions; the poor gather it up and eat, and the gardener smiles.

31 The gardener said: “Listen, O family of the tree, all you main branches and offshoots of every kind!

32 This wondrous tree is wholly spiritual and does the work of all the senses. Though rooted like any tree, it moves and acts like a living creature.[11]

33 All the limbs of this tree are conscious, and as they grow, they spread through all the worlds.

34 I am a lone gardener. How many places can I go to? How many fruits can I pick and give away by Myself?

35 It is hard work to pick them and give them out alone, and I am left in doubt: some will receive them, and some will not.

36 Therefore I give this order to all of you: wherever you are, give the fruit of love to anyone and everyone.[12]

37 I am a lone gardener. How many fruits can I eat? And if I do not give this fruit away, what else shall I do with it?

38 I water the tree unceasingly with the nectar of My own desire, and so it bears countless fruits.

39 Therefore give all these fruits away to anyone, and let people eat them and be free from old age and death.

40 My holy fame will spread through the world, and people will sing My glory with joy.

41 Let everyone who has taken human birth in the land of Bhārata make that birth fruitful by working for the good of others.[13]

42 'This alone is the true success of birth for embodied beings in this world: always to do good to others with one's life, wealth, intelligence and words.' (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.22.35)[14]

43 'By deeds, thoughts and words the wise should do only that which brings good to living beings, in this world and the next.' (Viṣṇu Purāṇa, 3.12.45)[15]

44 I am a gardener, a man with no kingdom and no riches. By giving away fruits and flowers I earn merit.

45 I am the gardener, and yet I have become the tree, for that was My wish: a tree benefits every living being.[16]

46 'Ah, how excellent is the birth of these trees, which sustains all living beings! Like a good man, they never let one who asks of them go away disappointed.'" (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.22.33)[17]

47 When the gardener Caitanya gave this order, the whole family of the tree was filled with joy.

48 Each branch began to give away the fruit of love everywhere, and all the people who tasted it became intoxicated.[18]

49 People ate their fill of this most intoxicating fruit of love, and, maddened by it, they all laughed, danced and sang.

50 Some rolled on the ground, some roared, and seeing this, the gardener smiled with delight.

51 The gardener Himself eats this fruit of love and remains ever intoxicated, helpless and overwhelmed.[19]

52 He made all people as intoxicated as Himself; I see no one who is not mad with love.

53 Even those who once reviled Him, calling Him a drunkard, ate that fruit and danced, crying, "Wonderful, wonderful!"[20]

54 Thus I have told of the distribution of the fruit of love. Now hear of the branches that give the fruit.

55 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. Heading in the edition: "By Gaura's mercy the impossible becomes possible." *Anubhāṣya*: *jagad-guru* — the guru of all the worlds, worthy of everyone's worship. ↩
2. Heading in the edition: "The gardener is Mahāprabhu Himself." *Anubhāṣya*: *amara-taru* — the unfading, imperishable tree, that is, the wish-fulfilling tree (*kalpa-vṛkṣa*); its fruits are the fruits of love for Kṛṣṇa. ↩
3. Heading in the edition: "Why He became the gardener: so that His being the Lord of *abhidheya*, the means to the goal, should bear fruit." ↩
4. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Śrī Mādhava Purī is Mādhavendra Purī, a renowned sannyāsī of the sampradāya of Śrī Madhvācārya; Śrī Caitanya is the disciple of his disciple. Before him there was no clear sign of prema-bhakti in the Madhva sampradāya, and his verse *ayi dīna-dayārdra nātha* holds, as a seed, what Mahāprabhu was to teach. ↩
5. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya* and *Anubhāṣya*: Śrī Īśvara Purī, the Guru who gave Mahāprabhu His mantra, was born into a brāhmaṇa family in Kumārahaṭṭa (Hālisahar) and was the dearest disciple of Śrī Mādhavendra Purī, whom he served with complete devotion (Antya 8.26–29). Before initiating Mahāprabhu

in Gayā he lived for some months in Navadvīpa in the house of Gopīnātha Ācārya and read Him his own *Kṛṣṇa-līlāmṛta* (*Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Ādi 7). When Mahāprabhu came to Kumārahaṭṭa, He took earth from the place of Īśvara Purī's birth, teaching everyone devotion to the Guru. ↩

6. Heading in the edition: "Nine sannyāsīs — nine roots." *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the sannyāsīs named Purī are related by succession to Śrī Īśvara Purī, and those named Bhāratī to Keśava Bhāratī, who gave Mahāprabhu sannyāsa. *Anubhāṣya*: Keśava Bhāratī belonged to the Bhāratī branch of the orders of sannyāsa founded by Śaṅkara; some say he had received a mantra from Śrī Mādhavendra Purī and was a Vaiṣṇava sannyāsī. In Śaka 1432 (1510) he gave sannyāsa to Nimāi Paṇḍita in Kāṭoyā. Brahmānanda Purī sang with Mahāprabhu in the kīrtanas of Navadvīpa and came with Him to Nīlācala. Brahmānanda Bhāratī wore a deerskin; when Mahāprabhu came to him and pretended not to recognise him, he exchanged it for saffron cloth. ↩
7. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads *ei nava mūle* ("on these nine roots"); some other editions read *aṣṭa dike aṣṭa mūla* ("eight roots in the eight directions"). *Anubhāṣya*: Paramānanda Purī, a brāhmaṇa of Tirhut and a disciple of Śrī Mādhavendra Purī, was especially dear to Mahāprabhu; together with Svarūpa Dāmodara he was always at His side in Nīlācala (*Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya 3 and 11). The *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* names him as Uddhava. ↩
8. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads *nāma-gaṇana* ("the counting of the names"); some other editions read *nāma agaṇana* ("the names are countless"). The branches are named in Ādi 10–12. ↩
9. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads *vṛkṣera upare śākhā haila dui skandha* ("above, the branches of the tree became two trunks"); some other editions read *śākhāra upare haila vṛkṣa dui skandha*. Heading in the edition: "On either side of the main trunk, two trunks — Nitāi and Advaita." ↩
10. Heading in the edition: "Branches and offshoots — the succession of disciples and their disciples." ↩
11. Heading in the edition: "Every part of the Caitanya-tree is full of consciousness, and by tasting its conscious fruit the insentient jīva awakens to consciousness." ↩
12. Heading in the edition (to 34–38): "Seeing that spreading the Name and prema alone is impossible, He orders everyone to give them without discrimination." ↩
13. Heading in the edition: "Everyone born as a human being in the land of Bhārata is duty-bound to show people eternal mercy — to turn them towards Kṛṣṇa." *Anubhāṣya*: to be born as a human being in holy Bhāratavarṣa, the best of lands,

is to receive a body for the true and eternal good of the world; in this lies the success of such a birth. ↩

14. *Anubhāṣya*: Śrī Kṛṣṇa spoke these words to His cowherd friends when, after stealing the gopīs' garments, He had gone far with them and, resting beneath the trees, saw the trees' patience and readiness to serve others. The good (*śreyas*) here is eternal good: to free the jīva from aversion to the Lord and turn him towards Him; this is the highest expression of eternal mercy. Heading in the edition: "The highest mercy and the highest good is to turn the jīva towards devotion to Kṛṣṇa by deeds, thoughts and words." ↩
15. *Anubhāṣya*: the benefit (*upakāra*) is eternal good; what one should do is awaken in living beings the pious merit (*sukṛti*) that turns them towards devotion to the Lord. ↩
16. Heading in the edition: "Seeing the causeless mercy of the tree, He wished to become the original wish-fulfilling tree Himself." ↩
17. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads *sarva-prāṇy-upajīvanam* ("a birth that sustains all living beings"); some other editions read *upajīvinām*. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Kṛṣṇa says this addressing the trees: they are the sustenance of all beings and their birth is fruitful; no petitioner leaves them empty-handed — the trees behave like good people. ↩
18. Heading in the edition: "The fruit of prema is given regardless of qualification (*adhikāra*)." ↩
19. Heading in the edition (to 51–52): "By giving the jīvas love for Kṛṣṇa like His own, He makes them mahā-bhāgavatas." ↩
20. Heading in the edition: "Even the lowly blasphemers are delivered by receiving the fruit of love for Kṛṣṇa." ↩